



Social media

View customer's profile information on social media.

58%
of marketers
could link data
to an individual
customer
by 2012

Website trackers

Track website visitor's movement around a site and see what attracts interest.



Competitions

Use competitions to collect information, from opinions to demographic data.

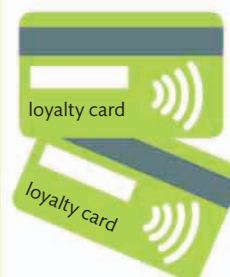


Transactions

Ask questions at checkout—in the store, online, or on the phone.

TECHNOLOGY AT THE CHECKOUT

In this technological age, businesses have the means to learn about their customers without bombarding them with questions. Retailers, for example, typically use three methods in stores to capture information about the customer.



Loyalty program

A company may collect information by inviting customers to register for a loyalty program that offers an incentive. A loyalty program also helps track customer preferences.



Point of sale software

Computer software programs that track a customer's purchases are available, allowing marketers to tailor offers to their spending habits.



Mobile technology

The use of smartphones enables marketers to compile data, for example the frequency of customer visits and the amount of time they spend in the store.